Vanta Business Documents + Contract Intelligence

Design Brief for the future Documents module

Status: Design only - do not build yet

Purpose: Define how Vanta should create, review, explain, and package business documents in plain English - with approvals, exports, and receipts.

Guardrail: Vanta helps users understand and prepare. It does not replace licensed legal advice.

Vanta Business Documents + Contract Intelligence — Design Brief

Do not build yet.

Do not implement yet.

Do not add routes.

Do not add tables.

Do not add migrations.

Do not add new AI calls.

Do not add new document-generation flows yet.

This is a future-facing design brief for a major Vanta module.

This module should not move into build mode until the current Command Center Daily Bulletin polish is complete, the front door is clean, and Export Polish basics are stable.

Working Name

Internal name:

Business Documents + Contract Intelligence

User-facing name:

Documents

Keep the user-facing name simple.

Do not overbrand it.

Product Promise

Vanta should help users create, review, explain, organize, and package business documents in plain English — with approvals, exports, and receipts.

Plain-English promise:

> “Upload or create a business document and Vanta will explain what it is, what it means, what matters, what could go wrong, and what needs your attention.”

Why This Belongs In Vanta

Vanta is a digital operational companion.

It already handles:

- uploads
- projects
- notes
- captures
- Living Briefs
- exports
- receipts
- plain-English summaries
- Sherlock-style background pattern detection
- Command Center bulletin
- PDF generation
- project organization

Business documents are part of operations.

Contracts, NDAs, agreements, invoices, proposals, leases, service agreements, and partnership documents should not live as random files.

They should connect to Projects, Living Briefs, Exports, and Receipts.

The clean model:

Projects handle operations.

Briefs handle summaries.

Documents handle agreements.

Receipts prove everything.

Command Center tells the user what changed.

Core Guardrail

Vanta helps users understand, organize, draft, and prepare business documents.

Vanta does not replace licensed legal advice.

Use a natural disclaimer:

> “Vanta can help you understand and prepare, but this does not replace a licensed attorney.”

Do not present Vanta as a lawyer.

Do not guarantee legal correctness.

Do not give jurisdiction-specific legal guarantees.

Do not allow automatic legal execution.

Do not allow automatic sending.

Do not allow e-signature or filing in the first versions.

Major Modes

The Documents module should eventually support two major modes:

1. Create documents

2. Analyze documents

Mode 1 — Create Documents

Vanta should help draft business documents such as:

- NDAs
- service agreements
- contracts
- partnership memos
- statements of work
- terms sheets
- business letters
- payment agreements
- contract summaries
- client-facing proposals
- internal policy documents

The flow must be approval-based.

Expected flow:

Project

→ Create Document

→ Choose type

→ Talk/type instructions or use guided setup

→ Vanta extracts structure

→ User reviews setup

→ Vanta drafts

→ User reviews

→ Export PDF/DOCX

→ Saved to Project

→ Receipts

Example user request:

> “Create a mutual NDA between Maxwell Wolfe and M. T. Global Health and Fitness Co., Ltd., governed by Thailand law, for platform development and business due diligence, five-year term, premium business style.”

Vanta should convert that into structured setup:

Document type: Mutual NDA

Parties: Maxwell Wolfe / M. T. Global Health and Fitness Co., Ltd.

Jurisdiction: Thailand

Purpose: platform development, business due diligence, partnership evaluation

Term: five years

Style: premium boardroom

Output: PDF / DOCX / plain-English summary / signature page

Then Vanta asks:

> “Want me to draft it?”

This preserves:

Plan → Approve → Execute

Vanta should never jump straight from a voice note or chat message into a final legal packet without review.

Mode 2 — Analyze Documents

Users should be able to upload:

- PDF
- DOCX
- image
- screenshot
- scanned contract
- email attachment
- proposal
- invoice
- lease
- terms page
- NDA

- service agreement
- partnership agreement

Vanta should return:

What this is

Example:

> “This appears to be a mutual NDA.”

Who is involved

Identify parties.

What it means in plain English

Example:

> “This basically says both sides agree not to share private business information.”

Important dates

Extract:

- term
- deadlines
- renewal dates
- expiration dates
- notice periods
- payment deadlines

Money terms

Extract:

- fees
- penalties
- payment deadlines
- deposits
- refunds
- late fees
- commissions
- revenue share if present

Obligations

What each side must do.

Restrictions

What each side cannot do.

Risks / red flags

Flag issues such as:

- one-sided terms
- unclear jurisdiction
- penalties
- vague scope
- missing termination clause
- unclear ownership language
- broad confidentiality obligations
- unusual payment conditions
- unclear dispute handling
- missing signatures
- unclear effective date

Missing or unclear

Identify what is absent or vague.

Questions to ask before signing

Examples:

- “What happens if the business relationship ends?”
- “Who owns the work product?”
- “Does confidentiality survive termination?”
- “Which court handles disputes?”
- “Who pays legal fees if there is a dispute?”
- “What happens if payment is late?”
- “Can either side terminate early?”
- “Are there any non-compete or exclusivity restrictions?”

Suggested next move

Example:

> “Review payment clause and ownership language before signing.”

Plain-English verdict

Example:

> “This is mostly normal, but these three parts need review.”

Explanation Style

The analysis should feel direct, useful, and plain English.

The “Harvey Specter” energy should be in the clarity and confidence of explanation, not in pretending Vanta is a lawyer.

Good style:

> “Here’s the deal: this clause gives them broad control over termination. That may be fine, but you need to know they can end this quickly while still keeping some obligations alive.”

Avoid legalese-heavy explanations like:

> “Pursuant to Section 7.2, one may observe…”

Avoid fear-based language.

Avoid fake certainty.

Avoid pretending to provide licensed legal advice.

Conversation / Voice / Type Interaction

The Documents module should support both spoken and typed interaction.

Users should be able to talk to Vanta like they talk to ChatGPT.

The interaction should not be limited to a small chat widget page.

Conversation should become a control layer across Vanta.

The old model of “go to a separate page and talk to a chat widget” should eventually be demoted.

The dedicated chat page can become:

Assistant History / Conversations

A place to review past discussions, not the only place interaction happens.

Conversational Control Layer

Users should be able to talk or type inside the workflow.

Examples:

Inside a Project:

> “Draft an NDA for this project.”

Inside a document review:

> “Explain clause 7 in street English.”

Inside a PDF preview:

> “Make this more serious and boardroom-ready.”

Inside a contract risk review:

> “Show me what could bite me later.”

Inside an export screen:

> “Add a signature page and make it look more premium.”

Inside a draft:

> “Make this stricter but still professional.”

Inside a document packet:

> “Create a client-ready version without internal notes.”

The interface should support:

Talk anywhere relevant.

Type anywhere relevant.

Convert discussion into action.

Attach results to Projects.

Export when ready.

Keep receipts.

Input Modes

The Documents module should eventually support three input modes:

1. Guided setup

Vanta asks step-by-step questions.

Examples:

- “Who are the parties?”
- “What is this agreement for?”
- “What jurisdiction should govern it?”
- “How long should it last?”
- “Do you want this to be mutual or one-way?”
- “Should this sound simple, boardroom-level, strict, friendly, or premium?”
- “Do you want a plain-English summary attached?”
- “Do you want a signature page?”
- “Do you want a visual cover page?”

2. Conversational setup

User talks or types naturally.

Vanta extracts the document setup.

Example:

> “Create a mutual NDA between Maxwell Wolfe and M. T. Global Health and Fitness, governed by Thailand law, for platform development and business due diligence, five-year term, premium business style.”

Vanta converts that into structured fields and asks for confirmation.

3. Upload / review setup

User uploads a document, screenshot, scanned contract, or file.

Vanta explains and reviews it.

Output Modes

The Documents module should eventually support three output modes:

1. Plain-English review

Explains:

- what this is
- what it means
- what matters

- what could go wrong
- what needs review

2. Draft / edit mode

Generates or revises:

- NDA
- contract
- SOW
- agreement
- proposal
- letter
- payment agreement
- internal policy

3. Export mode

Exports:

- PDF
- DOCX
- review packet
- signature-ready packet
- attorney review packet
- client-ready packet
- plain-English summary
- risk report

Customization Direction

Do not build a full theme customizer in Phase 1.

But design the Documents module so customization can be added later.

Future customization should include:

- document tone
- document strictness
- visual style
- cover page
- signature page
- confidentiality watermark
- font/spacing style
- executive summary
- plain-English side notes

- risk report
- source appendix
- internal-only notes
- client-facing version
- attorney-review version
- jurisdiction disclaimer
- premium packet look

Tone/style options might include:

- Simple
- Professional
- Boardroom
- Strict
- Friendly
- Premium

Audience/output options might include:

- Internal review
- Client-ready
- Signature-ready
- Attorney review
- Implementation packet
- Plain-English explanation
- Risk review

Same source material.

Different audience.

Different output.

Project Integration

Documents must connect directly to Projects.

A document uploaded inside a Project should not become a random file.

Example:

Inside Ground Stay, user uploads a partnership agreement.

Vanta should say:

> “New agreement uploaded. I can summarize the key terms, flag risks, and create a review brief.”

Then it can feed the Living Brief:

> “Ground Stay now has one uploaded agreement requiring review. Main issues appear to be confidentiality, payment responsibilities, and ownership of platform work.”

Potential project actions:

- Review document
- Explain in plain English
- Flag risks
- Create review brief
- Create red flag report
- Create client packet
- Create signature-ready draft
- Attach to Living Brief
- Export
- Save to Receipts

Document Export Types

The module should eventually support:

- Contract Review Brief
- Plain-English NDA Summary
- Red Flag Report
- Client Review Packet
- Signature-Ready Draft
- Attorney Handoff Packet
- Clause Summary
- Obligation Summary
- Payment Terms Summary
- Executive Summary
- Internal Notes Version
- Client-Facing Version

Receipts

Every major document action should produce receipts.

Receipt examples:

- document uploaded
- text extracted
- document reviewed
- risks identified
- draft created

- draft edited
- user approved draft
- export generated
- PDF saved
- DOCX saved
- attached to project
- added to Living Brief
- user requested attorney-review packet
- user dismissed a risk flag

Receipts should be plain English where user-facing.

Internal logs can stay technical.

Command Center Integration

After Command Center polish is complete, document activity should appear in the bulletin in plain English.

Examples:

- “New agreement added to Ground Stay.”
- “Ground Stay NDA review is ready.”
- “One contract risk needs review.”
- “Signature-ready NDA was exported.”
- “Payment terms summary saved.”
- “Attorney review packet created.”

Avoid:

- file upload complete
- document processed
- extraction complete
- vector index updated
- contract analysis event created

Legal / Trust Guardrails

Vanta must include a natural disclaimer where appropriate:

> “Vanta can help you understand and prepare, but this does not replace a licensed attorney.”

The disclaimer should appear in:

- document review
- contract analysis

- risk report
- legal draft creation
- signature-ready packet
- attorney review packet

Do not overdo the warning.

Keep it calm and trustworthy.

Do not make Vanta sound scared.

Do not make Vanta sound like a law firm.

Hard No List

Do not include in early phases:

- e-signature
- legal filing
- court filing
- automatic sending
- automatic execution
- jurisdiction-specific guarantee
- attorney impersonation
- final legal advice
- hidden changes to documents
- silent contract edits
- automatic agreement approval
- uncontrolled template generation
- raw legal hallucinations without review
- contract risk scoring as if objective/legal truth
- hidden AI edits without receipts

Roadmap Placement

Current priority:

1. Command Center Daily Bulletin polish

Must finish first.

No raw jargon on the front door.

2. Export Polish

Operator Brief + Client Brief first.

Contracts and NDAs need credible outputs.

If Vanta can draft or review documents but the PDF looks basic, the module will feel unfinished.

3. OpenCanvas Phase 2 / project visual support

Optional depending on flow.

Canvas can later help organize document terms, risks, obligations, timelines, and comparison maps.

4. Documents + Contract Intelligence Design Doc

Audit/design only.

No build yet.

Define flows, guardrails, inputs, outputs, disclaimers, project integration, voice/chat behavior, and export requirements.

5. Documents Phase 1 — Review Uploaded Documents

Build this before document generation.

Safer first step.

User uploads document or screenshot.

Vanta explains in plain English.

Vanta identifies parties, dates, obligations, risks, missing terms, and questions.

Vanta attaches results to Project.

Vanta can create a review brief.

Vanta can export.

Vanta keeps receipts.

6. Documents Phase 2 — Draft Basic Business Documents

Support:

- NDAs
- service agreements
- statements of work
- simple business letters
- payment agreements

All draft flows must use:

Plan → Approve → Execute

7. Documents Phase 3 — Conversational Document Builder

Add:

- voice setup
- typed setup
- follow-up questions
- style controls
- revision loop
- “make it stricter”
- “make it client-ready”
- “add signature page”
- “explain this clause”

8. Documents Phase 4 — Premium Document Packets

Add:

- cover page
- watermark
- signature pages
- plain-English summary
- risk appendix
- source appendix
- DOCX/PDF outputs
- client-ready packet
- attorney-review packet

Later Phases

Add:

- compare versions
- clause library
- obligation tracking
- renewal reminders
- signature packet prep
- attorney handoff packet
- business template vault
- clause risk categories
- project-level document timeline

Phase 1 Recommendation

When this module eventually enters build mode, start with:

Documents Phase 1 — Review Uploaded Documents

Do not start with document drafting.

Reason:

Reviewing uploaded documents is safer, validates the analysis layer, proves project integration, and supports immediate business use.

Phase 1 should support:

- upload PDF/DOCX/image/screenshot
- extract text if possible
- summarize in plain English
- identify parties
- identify dates
- identify money terms
- identify obligations
- identify restrictions
- identify risks/red flags
- identify missing/unclear sections
- suggest questions to ask
- attach to Project
- create review brief
- export PDF
- keep receipts

Acceptance Criteria For Future Design Doc

The future design doc is complete if it answers:

1. What document types Vanta should support.
2. How users can talk/type their way into a document setup.
3. How uploaded documents are analyzed.
4. How plain-English explanations are structured.
5. How risk flags are presented without pretending to be a lawyer.
6. How document drafting remains approval-based.
7. How documents attach to Projects.
8. How document activity appears in Command Center.
9. How documents export into polished packets.

10. How receipts prove what happened.
11. What customization is allowed now vs. later.
12. What is explicitly out of scope.
13. How legal disclaimers are handled.
14. How this connects to the existing Vanta flow.

Final Principle

This module should not feel like a legal form builder.

It should feel like a serious business document command studio inside Vanta.

The user should be able to say what they need, upload what they have, understand what they are dealing with, revise it, package it, and keep proof.

Vanta should explain documents in plain English, help prepare drafts, flag risks, organize everything by Project, export cleanly, and preserve receipts.

The goal is:

Create, review, explain, and package business documents in plain English — with approvals, exports, and receipts.